cancelling

A method of changing a fraction to its simplest form.



Examples

(i) Divide both numerator and denominator by three (common factor).

$$\frac{15}{21} \begin{matrix}\div 3\\ \div 3\end{matrix} = \frac{\cancel{15}^{\,5}}{\cancel{21}_{\,7}} = \frac{5}{7}$$

(ii) Divide across.

$$\frac{\cancel{15}^{\,3}}{\cancel{22}_{\,2}} \times \frac{\cancel{33}^{\,3}}{\cancel{40}_{\,8}} = \frac{3 \times 3}{2 \times 8} = \frac{9}{16}$$

See denominator, fraction, numerator, simple fraction, simplify

capacity

How much a container can hold. The number of cubic units a container can hold is called the capacity or volume of the container. Volume is the actual amount of material in the container.

Units of capacity are:

cubic centimetre	cm^3
cubic metre	m^3
millilitre	mL
litre	L
kilolitre	kL
megalitre	ML

1 mL = 1 cm^3
1000 mL = 1 L = 1000 cm^3
1000 L = 1 kL = 1 m^3

Example

An eye dropper holds about 1 millilitre of liquid, which fills one cubic centimetre.



See section Metric relationships on page 149, volume

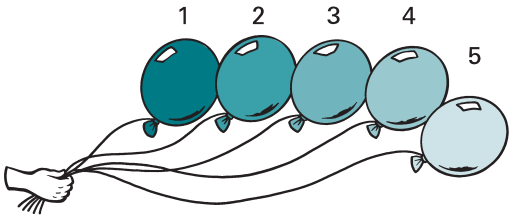
cardinal number

The number of all elements (members) in a set. When we count, we give each element one number, starting with 1. These numbers are in sequence. The last number given is the cardinal number of the set.

Example

How many balloons?

The cardinal number of this set of balloons is 5.



See counting, sequence, set

Carroll diagram

A method of recording a classification activity (used by Lewis Carroll).

Example

	black	not black
square		
not square		

See attribute, classify, diagram, sorting